strength, and to develop clever strategies and external balancing as moves to strengthen and enlarge one's own alliance or to weaken and shrink an opposing one.[29] Waltz's division of internal and external balancing strategies has since become the standard, but his definition of each strategy is relatively vague. Layne observes that balancing expresses the idea of counterweight and the ability to generate sufficient material capabilities to match, or offset, those of a would-be, or actual, hegemon.[30] Brooks and Wohlforth remind us that the concept of balancing rose to prominence "in a world in which great power security relations were dominated by the direct threat that they posed to each other,"[31] and they thus define balancing as "protection from the security threat emanating directly from a potential hegemon."[32] They also argue that, strictly speaking, balancing is a great power phenomenon, because "only great powers can prevent one among them from attaining geopolitical predominance."[33] Using the term *hard balancing* to describe the traditional realist school understanding of balancing, Paul argues that it requires a robust armament programme and an open arms build-up targeted at a rival state, noting that this is "a strategy often exhibited by states engaged in intense interstate rivalry" and that the nature of the rivalry State A conducts towards State B is intense and one where relative gains and zero-sum outcomes matter most.[34]

Rectifying imbalance of power through external balancing, by entering into a formal military alliance with another great power, is a straightforward hard balancing response. However, short of a military alliance, what kind of internal balancing response is required to qualify as hard balancing? If we use Paul's "intense interstate rivalry" as the point of departure, it is useful to note that "rivalry" literally means a state or situation in which rivals compete against each other, and it builds on the understanding of a "rival" as someone or